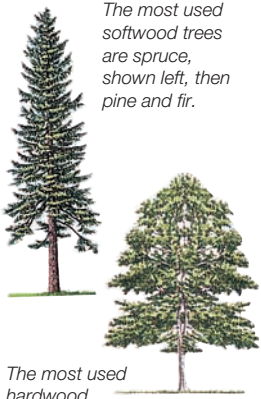




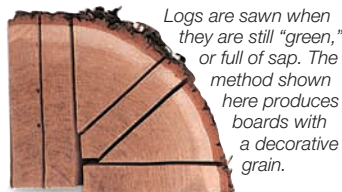
VANCOUVER

Situated between the mountains and the sea, Vancouver is an attractive city and an industrial center, as well as a busy port. Its ice-free harbor provides Canada with year-round access for trade with Asian countries across the Pacific Ocean. Many Chinese families settled here rather than staying in Hong Kong when it reverted to China in 1997.



The most used softwood trees are spruce, shown left, then pine and fir.

The most used hardwood trees are poplar, then birch, shown right, and maple.



Logs are sawn when they are still "green," or full of sap. The method shown here produces boards with a decorative grain.



WESTERN CANADA

A WEALTH OF NATURAL RESOURCES first attracted European settlers to the wilds of western Canada. Fur trappers, gold prospectors, and loggers all hoped to make their fortune from the land. Today, natural resources are still the basis of the economy. The fertile soils of the prairie provinces of Alberta, Manitoba, and Saskatchewan make up four-fifths of Canada's farmland. Fishing is a major industry along the Pacific coast, where the main catch is salmon, most of which is canned for export. By contrast, the remote Yukon, Northwest, and Nunavut territories have important reserves of gold, zinc, and lead. These territories are also the only part of Canada where the native peoples form the majority of the population.



At the sawmill the lumber is cut into planks or pulped for papermaking.

Logs may be floated downriver from the forests to the sawmills in the form of huge rafts.

LUMBER INDUSTRY

Moist winds from the Pacific Ocean deposit rain on the western slopes of the Rocky Mountains, making conditions ideal for trees to grow to enormous sizes. Canada is the world's largest exporter of forest products, and the province of British Columbia produces almost half of Canada's lumber. Some logs are still floated to the sawmills, but today logs are often transported by road or helicopter. Most of the lumber is softwood, used for building materials as well as for chopsticks for Japan.

TOTEM POLES

For generations, native peoples of the northwestern coast carved wooden totem poles to record their family trees. Part of a pole shows which of the main clans a family belongs to, such as the raven or the wolf clan. Totem poles often guarded doorways to village homes.



The animals carved on the totem pole are symbols of the family's ancestors.



LIVING IN THE WILD

Large parts of the extreme north of Canada are home to more animals than people. Although part of the area is forested most of it is icy wilderness known as tundra. Animals that live here are adapted to the very cold conditions, and waterproof fur helps them to survive the snow and ice. Caribou, or reindeer, live on the tundra but migrate to the forests farther south in winter to escape the cold. Grizzly bears are found in the Rocky Mountains and can be dangerous.

COAL, OIL, AND GAS WEALTH

Once grain and beef processing centers for the prairies, Edmonton and Calgary grew rich during the 1970s from the coal, oil, and gas found in the prairies and nearby Rocky Mountains. Now Edmonton boasts a gigantic shopping mall with a hockey rink, a swimming pool, a rollercoaster, and a hotel where people can stay during a shopping trip.